

PREMIUM

Pre-Departure Checklist

From visa granted to landing in Australia

2-4 weeks before departure

- Check your grant notification for your visa conditions, validity period, and permitted length of stay
- Check your passport's remaining validity against your travel dates
- Confirm flights and accommodation
- Arrange travel insurance - check whether your country has a Reciprocal Health Care Agreement with Australia, and what it does and doesn't cover
- Notify your bank/card providers of your travel dates and destination

The week before

- Save or print: passport photo page, visa grant notification, flight itinerary, accommodation confirmation, and any invitation/sponsor letter
- Share your itinerary and emergency contacts with someone at home
- There's no visa label to bring - your passport number alone is what's checked electronically

Day of travel

- Arrive at the airport with sufficient buffer time for an international departure
- Keep your passport and any printed documents in your hand luggage
- Complete Australia's incoming passenger declaration as instructed by your airline or on arrival

At the Australian border

Arriving with a visa doesn't automatically grant entry - an Australian Border Force officer makes the final decision at the border, and can ask questions consistent with your visa application. This is routine, not a sign of a problem.

- Be ready to briefly restate your purpose of visit and length of stay, consistent with your application
- Declare any food, plant, or animal products - Australia's biosecurity rules are strict and enforced at arrival, separately from your visa conditions
- Keep a note of the latest date you must leave by, per your grant notification's stay length